NewsBank inc.

2026 ELECTIONS - Contests taking shape in county - 24 Assembly seats will be on ballot; 5 legislators are termed out, creating an open field

March 22, 2026 | Los Angeles Daily News (CA)
Author: Linh Tat | Section: News | 1894 Words
Page: 3
OpenURL Link

All 24 Assembly seats representing Los Angeles County residents are up for election this year, and with no incumbent running in five of them, things could heat up as folks battle it out for the open seats.

The five races with no incumbent are Districts 34, 42, 65, 66 and 67, which are represented by Assemblymembers Tom Lackey, Jacqui Irwin, Mike Gipson, Al Muratsuchi and Sharon Quirk-Silva, respectively. All five current office holders are termed out and can't seek reelection.

Along with the Assembly races, eight state Senate seats — for a total of 32 legislative races — will appear on L.A. County ballots during the June 2 primary election. In some cases, an incumbent may have no one challenging him/her for reelection.

We won't know for sure until the California secretary of state releases the official list of certified candidates Thursday.

But according to preliminary lists of potential candidates — based on who filed with their local county election offices — it appears two current assemblymembers in L.A. County may end up running unopposed: Assemblymembers Mark Gonzalez, D-Los Angeles, and Tina McKinnor, D-Inglewood.

One more thing to note about the state legislative races: The top two vote-getters move on to the general election, regardless of political party. This is

the case even if one candidate gets over 50% of the votes in the primary election. And even in races with just two candidates in the primary, there will still be a general election.

Below is a tentative look at how L.A. County Assembly races are shaping up. The list can still change; we'll know next week who's officially on the ballot.

Voter registration data was taken from the secretary of state's latest registration report.

Assembly District 34

Four people have filed to run to replace termed-out Republican Assemblymember Tom Lackey. This includes three Republicans — Steve Fox, Charles Frederick Hughes and Manny Lin — and one Democrat, Randall Putz.

Assembly District 34 spans three counties: L.A., San Bernardino and Kern. It includes the communities of Barstow, Palmdale, Lancaster and Needles.

It is 30.4% Democratic, 39.5% Republican and 20.5% no party preference.

Assembly District 39

First elected in 2022, Assemblymember Juan Carrillo, D-Palmdale, is has filed to run again, as has Republican Paul Andre Marsh.

This district takes in parts of L.A. and San Bernardino counties. It includes parts of northern Antelope Valley and stretches into the San Bernardino counties of Adelanto, Hesperia and Victorville.

The district is 43.7% Democratic, 23.5% Republican and 24% no party preference.

Assembly District 40

Assemblymember Pilar Schiavo, D-Chatsworth, was first elected in 2022 and is seeking a third term. The four Republican candidates vying to unseat her are Elizabeth Wong Ahlers, Andreas Farmakalidis, Zhirayr Gumruyan and Ricky Tracy Hayes II.

This district represents communities in Santa Clarita Valley and northwestern San Fernando Valley.

The voter breakdown in this district is 40.4% Democratic, 30.3% Republican and 22.2% no party preference.

Assembly District 41

First-term Assemblymember John Harabedian, a Democrat, is seeking reelection. Also filed to run in this election is Republican Adam Christopher Vena.

This district represents voters in Pasadena, Altadena, La Cañada Flintridge, Monrovia and Sierra Madre in L.A. County and Rancho Cucamonga, Wrightwood and San Antonio Heights in San Bernardino County.

It is 44% Democratic, 28.5% Republican and 20.3% no party preference.

Assembly District 42

Termed-out Assemblymember Jacqui Irwin, D-Thousand Oaks, is running for a U.S. House seat to replace retiring Rep. Julia Brownley.

With no incumbent in this race, three people filed to run for Assembly District 42. They include Democrats Kelly Honig and Deborah Klein Lopez, as well as Rocky Rhodes, who did not list a party affiliation.

The district includes portions of Ventura and L.A. counties, including Simi Valley, Thousand Oaks, Calabasas and Pacific Palisades.

Voters here are 40% Democratic, 31.5% Republican and 20.9% no party preference.

Assembly District 43

Assemblymember Celeste Rodriguez, a Democrat, is hoping to be reelected to a second term. Republican Ricardo Benitez also filed to run.

This San Fernando Valley district represents residents in Pacoima, Mission Hills, Sylmar, Arleta, Sun Valley, Panorama City, Lake View Terrace, Valley Glen, Van Nuys and San Fernando.

The voter makeup is 52.3% Democratic, 16.3% Republican and 24.9% no party preference.

Assembly District 44

Democratic Assemblymember Nick Schultz is running for a second term. Republicans Carolyn Daniels and Charlotte Gerry have also filed to run in this district, which represents residents in the San Fernando Valley and stretches from Sherman Oaks east through North Hollywood and Burbank and north to La Crescenta.

Assembly District 44 is 48.9% Democratic, 20.8% Republican and 23.7% no party preference.

Assembly District 46

First elected in 2018, Democratic Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel is seeking reelection. Republican Tracey Schroeder has also filed to run, potentially setting up a rematch of the November 2024 race.

The winner will represent western San Fernando Valley in L.A. County and a small portion of Ventura County. Communities include Encino and Van Nuys near its eastern border and West Hills and Woodland Hills further west.

The district is 48.6% Democratic, 20.9% Republican and 23.6% no party preference.

Assembly District 48

Just like in District 46, the 48th Assembly race represents a possible rematch. Assemblymember Blanca Rubio, a Democrat first elected in 2016, is seeking a sixth and final term. Republican Dan Tran, whom Rubio beat two years ago, also filed to run.

The winner will represent a swath of the San Gabriel Valley, including West Covina, Baldwin Park, Glendora, Covina, Azusa, Duarte and Monrovia.

The district is 46.2% Democratic, 23.5% Republican and 23.2% no party preference.

Assembly District 49

First elected in a special election in February 2022, Assemblymember Mike Fong, a Democrat, has filed to run for reelection. Also filing is Republican Long “David” Liu, a possible repeat of the 2024 election.

The winner will represent communities in the San Gabriel Valley, including Alhambra, Arcadia, El Monte, Monterey Park, Rosemead, San Gabriel, San Marino, South Pasadena and Temple City.

The voter makeup in this district is 44.7% Democratic, 19.6% Republican and 30.2% no party preference.

Assembly District 51

First elected in 2022, Assemblymember Rick Chavez Zbur wants another term. Democrat Colin D. Hernandez and Republicans Michael Geraghty and Jake Head also filed to run here, as did Dick Lucas, who did not list a party affiliation.

The 51st District represents Hollywood, West Hollywood, Beverly Hills and Santa Monica.

The voter breakdown here is 57.3% Democratic, 13.6% Republican and 22.8% no party preference.

Assembly District 52

Elected two years ago, Democratic Assemblymember Jessica Caloza wants a second term. Republican challenger Andrea Lee Anderson has also filed to run in this district.

The winner will represent East Los Angeles, including the neighborhoods of Lincoln Heights, Highland Park, Glassell Park, Eagle Rock, Los Feliz, Silver Lake and Echo Park.

The district is 60.2% Democratic, 11.3% Republican and 22.6% no party preference.

Assembly District 53

Democratic Assemblymember Michelle Rodriguez is seeking a second term. Republican Rafaela Romero also filed to run here.

The district includes parts of L.A. and San Bernardino counties, including Pomona, Ontario, Chino, Upland and Montclair.

It is 44.8% Democratic, 24.2% Republican and 23.1% no party preference.

Assembly District 54

Assemblymember Mark Gonzalez, a Democrat, is running unopposed for a second term.

He represents a district that includes L.A.'s Koreatown, Westlake, Chinatown, Little Tokyo and Boyle Heights, as well as the cities of Vernon and Montebello.

The district is 56.4% Democratic, 12.6% Republican and 24.3% no party preference.

Assembly District 55

First elected to state office in 2021, Democratic Assemblymember Isaac Bryan is seeking reelection. Other filers include Democrat Ashley M. Brown, Republican Keith G. Cascio and William "Billion" Campbell, who did not list a party affiliation.

This district represents Crenshaw, Culver City, Ladera Heights, Mar Vista, Del Rey, Palms, Pico-Robertson, Beverly Grove and Mid-Wilshire.

The voter make-up of this district is 63.3% Democratic, 9.7% Republican and 20.7% no party preference.

Assembly District 56

Democratic Assemblymember Lisa Calderon, first elected in 2020, is expected to face off against Republican Jessica Martinez.

The winner will represent the southeastern parts of L.A. County and the San Gabriel Valley, including El Monte, Hacienda Heights, La Habra Heights, La Puente, Pico Rivera and Whittier.

The district is 46.3% Democratic, 22.8% Republican and 24.8% no party preference.

Assembly District 57

Democratic Assemblymember Sade Elhawary is running against Republican Constance Jewel Menzies.

The district represents South Central and Downtown L.A.

It is 59.5% Democratic, 8.6% Republican and 24% no party preference.

Assembly District 61

First elected in 2022, Assemblymember Tina McKinnor, a Democrat, is running unopposed.

Her district includes Inglewood, Westchester, Lennox, Hawthorne, Westmont and Lawndale.

It is 60% Democratic, 11% Republican and 21.6% no party preference.

Assembly District 62

It’s another possible rematch: This one between Democratic Assemblymember José Luis Solache, who is seeking a second term, and Republican Paul Irving Jones, whom Solache defeated two years ago.

This district represents voters in Bellflower, Huntington Park, Lakewood, Lynwood, Maywood, Paramount, South Gate and Walnut Park.

It is 53.6% Democratic, 17.3% Republican and 22.5% no party preference.

Assembly District 64

Just like in the 2024 general election, Assemblymember Blanca Pacheco, a Democrat, will face off against Republican Raul Ortiz Jr. this year.

The two will battle it out to represent Southeast L.A. including Bell, Bell Gardens, Cudahy, Downey, East Whittier, La Mirada, Norwalk, Santa Fe Springs, South Whittier and La Habra.

The district is comprised of 48.5% Democrats and 23.1% Republicans. Another 21.8% have no party preference.

Assembly District 65

With Assemblymember Mike Gipson, D-Carson, termed out and running for a state Board of Equalization seat, six people filed to run in this wide-open race.

The candidates include Democrats Vinson Eugene Allen, Ayanna Davis, Fatima Iqbal-Zubair, Lamar Lyons and Magali Sanchez-Hall. Lydia Gutiérrez is the lone Republican on the list.

This district stretches from the Port of Los Angeles up to Compton and includes parts of Carson and Long Beach.

Its voter make-up is 56.5% Democratic, 12.9% Republican and 23% no party preference.

Assembly District 66

Termed-out Assemblymember Al Muratsuchi is running to become California’s superintendent of public instruction.

In the meantime, six people filed to replace Muratsuchi in the Assembly. They include Sara Deen, Scott Houston, Shannon Ruiz-Ross and Paul Seo, all Democrats. The two Republicans in the race are George Barks and Jessica Zonia Maldonado.

The 66th Assembly District includes many of L.A. County’s South Bay communities, stretching from El Segundo and Manhattan Beach southward through Torrance and San Pedro.

The district is 43.3% Democratic, 26.9% Republican and 23.1% no party preference.

Assembly District 67

Six people filed to run in this race since Assemblymember Sharon Quirk-Silva, D-Fullerton, is termed out.

Those who filed include Adrian Oscar Ayub, Ada Briceño, Paul Gonzales, Paulo Morales, Mark Pulido and Ali Taj. Ayub and Morales are Republicans; the rest are Democrats.

This district includes Buena Park, Cypress and Fullerton in Orange County, as well as some communities in

southern L.A. County.

About 41.7% of voters here are registered Democrats. Another 27.8% are registered Republicans. No party preference accounts for 24.8% of voters here.

Assembly District 69

Assemblymember Josh Lowenthal, first elected in 2022, is seeking a third term. Carolyn Essex, a fellow Democrat, also filed to run in this race.

The winner will represent parts of southern L.A. County, including Avalon, Carson and Long Beach.

This district is 51.3% Democratic, 18.5% Republican and 22.4% no party preference.

SCNG's Mona Darwish, Erika I. Ritchie and Kaitlyn Schallhorn contributed to this report.

ltat@scng.com

Copyright (c) 2026 Daily News of Los Angeles

- **Citation (apa Style)**
  Tat, L. (2026, March 22). 2026 ELECTIONS Contests taking shape in county - 24 Assembly seats will be on ballot; 5 legislators are termed out, creating an open field. *Daily News of Los Angeles (CA)*, p. 3. Available from NewsBank: Access World News – Historical and Current: https://infoweb.newsbank.com/apps/news/document-view?p=WORLDNEWS&docref=news/1A6FEEDA87334AD0.